

Recollection of the Saṅgha

Saṅghānusmṛti · Toh 281 · Derge Kangyur

དག་འདུ་རྒྱུ་སྤྱོད་པ།

Toh 281 in the Kangyur is a short liturgical text known in Sanskrit as the Saṅghānusmṛti and in Tibetan as Dge 'dun rjes su dran pa, meaning "Recollection of the Saṅgha." It belongs to a traditional set of devotional recollections — which also include the recollection of the Buddha and the Dharma — and enumerates the noble qualities of the ārya saṅgha, praising the community of noble practitioners as having entered the path well, rightly, harmoniously, and straightforwardly, and as being supremely worthy of homage, reverence, and generosity. As a brief praise and recollection text, it functions both as a devotional practice and as a concise doctrinal statement of what makes the saṅgha a refuge and a field of merit. It is classified among the sūtra-related works of the Kangyur and would traditionally be recited alongside its companion recollection texts as part of foundational Buddhist practice.

This concludes the preceding text.

In the language of India: Saṅghānusmṛti. In the language of Tibet: Recollection of the Saṅgha.

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

The noble Saṅgha (ārya saṅgha) has entered well, has entered rightly, has entered harmoniously, has entered straightforwardly. It is worthy of homage, worthy of reverence with palms pressed together. It is possessed of great and fully purified virtue, fully purifying merit. It is worthy of generosity, the supreme field of generosity for all —

Translator's Notes

- The text breaks off mid-sentence at the final line, ending with "the supreme field of generosity for all —" without completion. This is a standard opening formula for the Saṅghānusmṛti, a recollection of the Saṅgha text well attested in both Sanskrit and Tibetan; the phrasing closely parallels the canonical Saṅghānusmṛti found in the Pāli and Sanskrit traditions. The phrase རྒྱུ་སྤྱོད་པ། at the very beginning marks the end of a preceding separate text; the Saṅghānusmṛti then begins fresh with its own title colophon.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.